



Hezlett Primary School

Attendance Policy

Oct 2023

ATTENDANCE POLICY

Hezlett Primary School is committed to providing a full and efficient education to all pupils. We embrace the concept of equal opportunities for all. We will endeavour to provide an environment where all pupils feel valued and welcome.

For a child to reach their full educational achievement a high level of school attendance is essential. We will consistently work towards a goal of 100% attendance for all children. Every opportunity will be used to convey to pupils and their parents or carers the importance of regular and punctual attendance.

School attendance is subject to various Education laws and this school attendance policy is written to reflect these laws and the guidance produced by the Department of Education.

School Procedures

Any child who is absent from school at the morning or afternoon registration period must have their absence recorded as being authorised, unauthorised or as an approved educational activity [attendance out of school]. The school uses Attendance Manager by SIMS to collect, store and monitor all aspects of pupil attendance. If there is no known reason for the absence at registration, then the absence must be recorded in the first instance as unauthorised.

Lateness

Morning registration will take place at the start of school at 9.00 am. The registers will remain open for 15 minutes. Any pupil arriving after this time will be marked as having an unauthorised absence unless there is an acceptable explanation i.e. school transport was delayed. In cases for example, where the absence at registration was for attending an early morning medical appointment, the appropriate authorized absence code will be entered.

Pupils arriving after the start of school but before the end of the registration period will be treated for statistical purposes, as present, but will be coded as late before registers close. Repeated lateness will be discussed with parents and if no improvement is forthcoming, then the pattern will be reported to the EWO.

If children have to miss school for illness or any other reason, then parents must send a note of explanation, email the school or ring the office. Parents should try to arrange doctor or dentist's appointments for outside school hours whenever possible. If you require your child out of school early, a note should be sent to the class teacher. Children are encouraged to play outside at break and lunch times, except in bad weather. If your child has an injury which means that it is not advisable for them to play outdoors, then the teacher should be notified in writing.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Responsibilities of Parents

Parents are responsible for ensuring their children attend school regularly and punctually. The school will work in close collaboration with the parent to resolve any attendance issues.

- To ensure that their child attends school regularly and punctually
- To inform the school as soon as possible, on the first day of their child's absence
- To provide a written explanation for any absences on the child's return to school
- To avoid taking holidays during term time
- To work alongside the school to support pupil attendance.

Responsibilities of school:

- To ensure its registration system is accurate and consistently used by staff.
- To analyse data regularly and identify the actions that need to be taken
- To follow up unexplained absences
- To promote good attendance and punctuality
- To work in partnership with families and the Education Welfare Service
- To set and monitor progress towards annual targets for attendance
- To evaluate the effectiveness of the Attendance Policy

Responsibilities of the Educational Welfare Service:

- To monitor registers regularly
- To identify pupils/families with attendance difficulties
- To agree time-limited action which needs to be taken by the school or EWO
- Provide advice and work in partnership with school and parents

Monitoring Attendance

- Attendance is monitored regularly by the principal
- Teachers should inform the principal if they notice patterns of absence
- Attendance data will be discussed with the EWO as and when required
- An annual attendance target will be set and reviewed each year
- The principal will report to the governors on pupil attendance
- Individual pupil attendance will be reported to parents at the end of the school year.

First Day Absence

The child will be marked absent according to the codes laid out in Appendix 1.

Continuing Absence

If there is no contact from parent, or explanation for the absence, after the third day, the school will attempt to contact the parent by telephone, or e-mail or letter.

Ten Day's Absence

Any pupil who is absent without an explanation for 10 consecutive days will be notified to the Education Welfare Office. (E.W.O.)

Frequent Absence

In cases where a pupil begins to develop a pattern of absences, the school will try to resolve the problem with the parent/s. Initially the class teacher will speak with the parent. If this is unsuccessful, the principal will speak with the parent when the % attendance falls to below 90%. If this too is unsuccessful, the school will send parents a letter, informing them that they are seeking advice from the school's Education Welfare Officer (E.W.O.) Elvin Cochrane. This will happen if the child's attendance falls to below 85%. For example, 90% is 1 day of absence each fortnight.

A Welcome Back

It is important that on return from an absence that all pupils are made to feel welcome. This should include ensuring that the pupil is helped to catch up on

missed work and brought up to date on any information that has been passed to the other pupils.

Promoting attendance

The school will use opportunities as they arise to remind parents/carers, that it is their responsibility to ensure that their children receive their education.

Holidays in term time

Holidays during term time are to be discouraged. Parents will be reminded of the effect that absence can have on a pupil's potential achievement.

To be reviewed in October 2026

APPENDIX 1

Absence Codes: Guidance for Schools

CODE DESCRIPTION MEANING

/ Present (AM) Present

\ Present (PM) Present

A Artistic Endeavour Authorised Absence

B Bereavement Authorised Absence

C Suspended Unauthorised absence

D No reason provided for absence Approved Education Activity

F Family holiday (agreed) Authorised absence

G Family holiday (NOT agreed or days in excess of agreement) Unauthorised Absence

H Other Absence Unauthorised Absence

I Illness (NOT medical or dental etc. appointments) Authorised Absence

L Late (before registers closed) Present

M Medical/Dental appointments Authorised Absence

N No reason yet provided for absence Unauthorised Absence

O Other Exceptional Circumstances Authorised Absence

P Approved sporting activity Approved Education Activity

R Religious observance Authorised Absence

S Study leave Approved Educational Activity

U Late (after registers closed) Unauthorised absence

V Educational visit or trip Approved Education Activity

W Work experience Approved Education Activity

X Only Staff Should Attend Attendance not required

Y Exceptional closure Attendance not required

* Pupil not yet on roll Attendance not required

Holiday For All Attendance not required

! No Attendance Required Attendance not required

1 Alternative Education Provision (organised by the ELB) Approved Education Activity

- 2 Home/hospital tuition (organised by the ELB) Approved Education Activity
- 3 Elective Home Education Approved Education Activity
- 4 Pupil Referral Unit Approved Education Activity
- 5 Another mainstream school (under Entitlement framework – EF) Approved Education Activity
- 6 Training organisation (under EF) Approved Education Activity
- 7 FE College (under EF) Approved Education Activity
- 8 Intensive Support Learning Unit Approved Education Activity
- 9 CAMHS Approved Education Activity